# MediScan AI - Product Requirements Document

**Version:** 1.0
**Date:** March 17, 2026
**Status:** Proof of Concept
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## Executive Summary

**MediScan AI** is an explainable artificial intelligence platform designed to serve as a **"Second Opinion as a Service"** for radiologists and clinicians analyzing chest X-rays. Rather than replacing clinical judgment, MediScan AI reduces radiologist burnout by automating the detection of common pathologies—particularly pneumonia—and providing interpretable visual explanations through Grad-CAM heatmaps. The platform emphasizes **model transparency** and **clinical usability**, enabling healthcare professionals to understand *why* the model made a specific prediction before making diagnostic decisions.

The core value proposition is simple: **Upload → Analyze → Visualize → Report**. In a 6-hour hackathon environment, the focus is entirely on model consumption (using pre-trained weights) and user experience, avoiding the computational overhead of training custom models.

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## 1. Problem Statement

### 1.1 Clinical Context

Chest X-ray interpretation is one of the most frequently performed diagnostic procedures globally, with an estimated **2 billion chest radiographs** acquired annually [1]. However, radiologists face significant challenges:

- **Cognitive Overload:** Radiologists interpret hundreds of images daily, leading to fatigue and increased diagnostic error rates [2].
- **Diagnostic Variability:** Inter-observer agreement for pneumonia detection ranges from 70–85%, depending on severity and radiologist experience [3].
- **Burnout Crisis:** The radiology workforce shortage is exacerbated by repetitive, high-volume workloads [4].
- **Accessibility Gap:** In resource-limited settings, trained radiologists are scarce, delaying diagnosis and treatment [5].

### 1.2 Existing Solutions & Limitations

Current commercial solutions (e.g., IBM Watson, GE Healthcare AI) either:

- Lack interpretability, making clinicians hesitant to trust predictions ("black box" problem)
- Require extensive fine-tuning on proprietary datasets, increasing deployment time
- Are prohibitively expensive for small clinics or research institutions
- Provide confidence scores without visual localization, limiting clinical utility

### 1.3 The Opportunity

A lightweight, explainable, and rapidly deployable AI system can:

1. Highlight regions of interest in seconds, reducing time-to-diagnosis
2. Provide confidence scores for multiple pathologies (pneumonia, effusion, etc.)
3. Generate structured clinical reports for integration into existing EHR systems
4. Serve as a triage tool to prioritize urgent cases

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## 2. Proposed Solution

### 2.1 Product Vision

**MediScan AI** is a web-based clinical decision support system that:

1. **Accepts** chest X-ray images (JPEG/PNG) via intuitive drag-and-drop interface
2. **Analyzes** images using a pre-trained deep learning model in real-time
3. **Visualizes** model predictions with Grad-CAM heatmaps showing areas of diagnostic interest
4. **Reports** findings with confidence scores, doctor's notes, and downloadable PDF summaries

## 2.2 Core Features

| Feature | Description | Clinical Benefit |
|---|---|---|
| **Drag-and-Drop Upload** | React-Dropzone integration for seamless file handling | Reduces friction; supports batch uploads |
| **Real-Time Inference** | Pre-trained ResNet50/DenseNet121 on GPU | Sub-second analysis for urgent cases |
| **Grad-CAM Heatmaps** | Visual explanation of model attention | Builds clinician trust; aids differential diagnosis |
| **Confidence Scores** | Multi-class probabilities (Pneumonia, Effusion, Normal) | Quantifies uncertainty; supports triage |
| **Doctor's Notes** | Free-text clinical observations | Integrates AI findings with clinical context |
| **PDF Reports** | Exportable summaries with images, heatmaps, and notes | Facilitates documentation and consultation |
| **Sample Dataset** | 6 pre-loaded X-rays (3 normal, 3 abnormal) | Enables immediate demo without external data |

### 2.3 User Personas

| Persona | Use Case | Key Needs |
|---|---|---|
| **Radiologist** | Rapid triage and second opinion | Speed, accuracy, explainability |
| **Emergency Physician** | Bedside pneumonia screening | Simplicity, confidence scores, mobile-friendly |
| **Researcher** | Validation of AI models on new datasets | API access, batch processing, audit trails |
| **Clinic Administrator** | Workflow integration | DICOM support (future), EHR integration (future) |

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## 3. AI/ML Approach

### 3.1 Model Architecture

**MediScan AI** uses **transfer learning** with pre-trained convolutional neural networks, eliminating the need for 6-month training cycles:

| Component | Choice | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| **Base Model** | ResNet50 or DenseNet121 | ImageNet pre-trained; proven on medical imaging; fast inference |
| **Input Size** | 224×224 pixels | Standard for ImageNet; balances speed and detail |
| **Output Classes** | 3 (Normal, Pneumonia, Effusion) | Focus on high-prevalence pathologies; extensible to 14+ diseases |
| **Framework** | PyTorch | Efficient, well-documented, excellent for research |

## 3.2 Inference Pipeline

```
Input X-ray (JPEG/PNG)
    ↓
[Preprocessing] Resize to 224×224, normalize (ImageNet stats)
    ↓
[Model Inference] Forward pass through ResNet50/DenseNet121
    ↓
[Output] Logits → Softmax → Confidence scores (0–100%)
    ↓
[Grad-CAM] Compute gradients w.r.t. last conv layer
    ↓
[Heatmap] Generate attention map; overlay on original image
    ↓
[Report] Combine image, heatmap, scores, notes → PDF
```

## 3.3 Grad-CAM for Explainability

**Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping (Grad-CAM)** is a technique that produces visual explanations for predictions by computing the gradient of the target class with respect to the final convolutional layer [6]:

$$\text{Grad-CAM}^c = \text{ReLU}\left(\sum_k \alpha_k^c A_k\right)$$

Where:

- $A_k$ = activation maps from the final convolutional layer
- $\alpha_k^c$ = gradient weights (average pooled gradients)
- $c$ = target class (e.g., “Pneumonia”)

**Clinical Interpretation:** The resulting heatmap highlights regions the model considers most relevant for its prediction. Red regions indicate high model confidence; blue regions indicate low confidence. This allows clinicians to verify whether the model is focusing on clinically meaningful features (e.g., consolidation patterns) or artifacts.

## 3.4 Image Quality Gatekeeper (Critical Functional Fix #1)

Before running the main diagnostic model, MediScan AI implements a **lightweight binary classifier** to validate scan quality and orientation:

**Purpose:** Reject invalid scans immediately with clear user feedback

**Implementation:**

- Use a lightweight binary classifier (or basic OpenCV edge-detection logic) trained to distinguish valid anterior-posterior (AP) chest X-rays from other imaging modalities
- Alternative: Implement histogram-based edge detection to verify anatomical landmarks (ribs, heart silhouette, diaphragm)

**User Experience:**

- If scan is invalid: Display error message: **"Invalid Scan Detected. Please upload a valid anterior-posterior chest X-ray (AP view)."**
- If scan is valid: Proceed to main inference pipeline

**Clinical Benefit:** Prevents wasted computation on non-diagnostic images; builds user confidence by catching errors early

**Technical Integration:** Runs as first step in preprocessing pipeline; adds <50ms latency

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## 3.5 Model Performance Expectations

Based on published benchmarks [7] [8]:

| Metric | ResNet50 | DenseNet121 |
|---|---|---|
| **Sensitivity (Pneumonia)** | 88–92% | 90–94% |
| **Specificity (Pneumonia)** | 85–89% | 87–91% |
| **Inference Time (per image)** | 50–100ms | 60–120ms |
| **Model Size** | 100MB | 30MB |

**Note:** These are estimates from public datasets (NIH, CheXpert). Actual performance depends on dataset distribution and fine-tuning.

## 3.6 Confidence Floor & Uncertainty Handling (Critical Functional Fix #2)

MediScan AI implements a **confidence threshold** to acknowledge uncertainty and build clinician trust:

**Rule:** If the model's highest predicted probability is **< 70%**, disable Grad-CAM visualization and display a warning

**User Experience:**

- Confidence ≥ 70%: Display full analysis with Grad-CAM heatmap
- Confidence < 70%: Display warning: **"Uncertain Clinical Presentation. Manual Radiologist Review Required."**
- Disable heatmap overlay to prevent misleading visual explanations
- Show raw confidence scores for transparency

**Clinical Benefit:**

- Acknowledges model uncertainty; prevents false confidence
- Encourages clinician judgment for ambiguous cases
- Builds massive trust with medical professionals by being honest about limitations
- Reduces liability by avoiding overconfident predictions

**Technical Integration:** Added as post-processing step after softmax; no additional latency

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## 3.7 Smart Triage Worklist (Critical Functional Fix #3)

Instead of a simple upload screen, MediScan AI simulates a **radiologist's pending worklist** with intelligent case prioritization:

**UI Feature: "Pending Worklist"**

- Display incoming scans (10 in demo) in a table format
- Show thumbnail, patient ID, upload time, and current pneumonia probability
- Automatically re-order queue: Cases with P(Pneumonia) > 0.90 pushed to top for urgent review

**Prioritization Logic:**

```
Priority 1 (Urgent):   P(Pneumonia) > 0.90
Priority 2 (High):     0.70 < P(Pneumonia) ≤ 0.90
Priority 3 (Standard): 0.40 < P(Pneumonia) ≤ 0.70
Priority 4 (Low):      P(Pneumonia) ≤ 0.40
```

**Clinical Benefit:**

- Mimics real radiologist workflow: urgent cases bubble to top
- Reduces time-to-diagnosis for critical patients
- Demonstrates AI's ability to optimize clinical operations
- Shows judges that MediScan AI is not just a tool, but a workflow optimizer

**Technical Implementation:**

- Backend: Store analysis results with timestamps and priority scores
- Frontend: Sort worklist dynamically; use color-coded badges (Red = Urgent, Yellow = High, Green = Standard)
- Demo: Pre-load 10 sample analyses to show prioritization in action

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# 4. Data Sources & Strategy

## 4.1 Pre-trained Weights

MediScan AI leverages publicly available pre-trained models:

| Source | Model | License | Use Case |
|---|---|---|---|
| **TorchVision** | ResNet50 (ImageNet) | BSD | General-purpose baseline |
| **TensorFlow Hub** | DenseNet121 (ImageNet) | Apache 2.0 | Alternative backbone |
| **Kaggle** | Chest X-ray weights (fine-tuned) | CC0 | Domain-specific initialization |
| **GitHub (mlmed/torchxrayvision)** | CheXpert-trained models | Apache 2.0 | Production-grade weights |

## 4.2 Sample Dataset Strategy

For the 6-hour hackathon, we use a **curated subset** of publicly available datasets:

| Dataset | Images | Source | License |
|---|---|---|---|
| **NIH Chest X-ray** | 112,120 total; 6 selected | NIH Clinical Center [9] | Public Domain |
| **CheXpert** | 224,316 total; available via Kaggle | Stanford University [10] | CC0 |
| **COVID-19 Pneumonia Dataset** | 3,616 total; 3 selected | Kaggle [11] | CC0 |

**Demo Dataset:** 6 carefully selected images (3 normal, 3 abnormal) are pre-loaded into the application, enabling immediate demonstration without external downloads.

## 4.3 Data Privacy & Compliance

- All sample images are **de-identified** (no PHI/PII)
- No patient data is stored on the server
- Uploaded images are processed in-memory and discarded after analysis
- Compliance path for HIPAA (future): encrypted storage, audit logs, access controls

### 4.4 Mock DICOM Pipeline (Critical Functional Fix #4)

Even though the frontend demo uses JPEGs for speed, the backend implements a **complete DICOM pipeline** to demonstrate production readiness:

**Backend Endpoint:** `/api/upload-dicom`

- Accept DICOM files ( `.dcm` format)
- Extract pixel array using `pydicom` library
- Parse patient metadata (Patient ID, Study Date, Modality, etc.)
- Normalize pixel values to 0-255 range
- Pass to inference pipeline

**Implementation Details:**

```python
import pydicom
from pydicom.data import get_testdata_files

@app.route('/api/upload-dicom', methods=['POST'])
def upload_dicom():
    dicom_file = request.files['file']
    ds = pydicom.dcmread(dicom_file)

    # Extract metadata
    patient_id = ds.PatientID
    study_date = ds.StudyDate
    modality = ds.Modality

    # Extract pixel array
    pixel_array = ds.pixel_array
    pixel_array = ((pixel_array - pixel_array.min()) / (pixel_array.max() - 
pixel_array.min()) * 255).astype(np.uint8)

    # Run inference
    predictions, heatmap = run_inference(pixel_array)

    return {
        'patient_id': patient_id,
        'study_date': study_date,
        'modality': modality,
        'predictions': predictions,
        'heatmap': heatmap
    }
```

**Clinical Benefit:**

- Demonstrates production-grade DICOM support
- Shows judges that the system is designed for real hospital integration
- Enables future EHR integration without major refactoring
- Preserves patient metadata for audit trails

**Demo Strategy:**

- Frontend uses JPEGs for speed (no waiting for DICOM parsing)
- Backend documentation shows DICOM endpoint is ready
- Include DICOM support in API documentation

- Future Phase 2 will enable DICOM uploads in frontend

**Dependencies:**

```
pydicom==2.4.0
```

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# 5. Technical Stack

## 5.1 Architecture Overview

```
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                        Frontend (React 19)                    │
│   ┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐   │
│   │ File Upload (react-dropzone) → Image Preview → Analysis │   │
│   │ Grad-CAM Heatmap Display → Confidence Chart (Recharts)  │   │
│   │ Doctor's Notes → PDF Export (jsPDF)                     │   │
│   └──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘   │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
                              ↓ (tRPC + Fetch)
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│                     Backend (Express + Python)                │
│   ┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐   │
│   │ tRPC Router: /api/trpc/analysis.predict                 │   │
│   │ Python Worker: PyTorch inference + Grad-CAM generation  │   │
│   │ Database (MySQL): Analysis history, user sessions       │   │
│   └──────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘   │
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

## 5.2 Technology Choices

| Layer | Technology | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| **Frontend** | React 19 + Tailwind CSS 4 | Fast, accessible, professional UI |
| **File Upload** | react-dropzone | Seamless UX; supports drag-and-drop |
| **Charts** | Recharts | Lightweight; integrates with React |
| **PDF Export** | jsPDF | Client-side generation; no server overhead |
| **Backend API** | Express.js + tRPC | Type-safe RPC; built into Manus scaffold |
| **ML Framework** | PyTorch | Industry standard; excellent GPU support |
| **Model Loading** | TorchVision + Hugging Face | Pre-trained weights; easy integration |
| **Grad-CAM** | pytorch-grad-cam library | Battle-tested; minimal dependencies |
| **Database** | MySQL (Drizzle ORM) | Persistent storage; audit trails |
| **Deployment** | Manus Platform | Managed hosting; automatic scaling |

## 5.3 Dependencies

### Frontend:

```
{
  "react": "^19.2.1",
  "react-dropzone": "^14.2.3",
  "recharts": "^2.15.2",
  "jspdf": "^2.5.1",
  "html2canvas": "^1.4.1",
  "axios": "^1.12.0"
}
```

### Backend:

```
torch==2.1.0
torchvision==0.16.0
pytorch-grad-cam==1.4.6
pillow==10.0.0
numpy==1.24.0
opencv-python==4.8.0
```

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# 6. Prototype Plan (6-Hour Execution) - Enhanced with Functional Fixes

## Timeline & Milestones (Updated)

| Hour | Phase | Deliverable | Success Criteria |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | Skeleton | React upload UI + Flask endpoints + Image Quality Gatekeeper | Drag-and-drop works; API responds; invalid scans rejected |
| **2–3** | Brain | Model loading + inference + Grad-CAM + Confidence Floor | Predictions generated; heatmaps render; uncertainty handled |
| **4–5** | Visuals | Frontend integration + PDF export + Smart Triage Worklist | Side-by-side display; reports downloadable; prioritized worklist |
| **6** | Polish | Sample data + styling + demo video + DICOM pipeline docs | Live demo works; fallback video recorded; DICOM endpoint documented |

## Hour-by-Hour Breakdown

### **Hour 1: The “Skeleton” (Enhanced)”

**Frontend:**

- Initialize React app with `react-dropzone` component
- Create upload zone with drag-and-drop styling

- Add image preview component
- **NEW:** Add error handling UI for invalid scans

**Backend:**

- Set up Flask server with `/api/predict` endpoint
- Create `/api/report` endpoint stub
- **NEW:** Implement Image Quality Gatekeeper (binary classifier or OpenCV edge detection)
- Test endpoints with curl/Postman

**Deliverable:** User can drag an image into the browser; backend receives the file; invalid scans are rejected with clear error message..

****Hours 2–3: The "Brain" (Enhanced)"**

**Model Loading:**

- Download pre-trained ResNet50 weights from TorchVision
- Implement image preprocessing (resize, normalize)
- Create inference function that returns confidence scores

**Grad-CAM Integration:**

- Install `pytorch-grad-cam` library
- Implement Grad-CAM computation for the pneumonia class
- Generate heatmap overlay on original image
- **NEW:** Implement Confidence Floor logic (disable heatmap if confidence < 70%)

**DICOM Pipeline (Backend):**

- **NEW:** Install `pydicom` library
- **NEW:** Create `/api/upload-dicom` endpoint (documented but not used in frontend demo)
- **NEW:** Implement pixel array extraction and metadata parsing

**Deliverable:** Backend returns JSON with `{ predictions: {...}, heatmap: "base64_encoded_image", confidence_floor_triggered: false }`. DICOM endpoint is functional and documented..

****Hours 4–5: The "Visuals" (Enhanced)"**

**Frontend Integration:**

- Connect upload to `/api/predict` endpoint
- Display original image + heatmap side-by-side
- Render confidence scores as bar chart (Recharts)
- Add doctor's notes textarea
- **NEW:** Implement Confidence Floor UI (show warning if confidence < 70%; disable heatmap)

**Smart Triage Worklist:**

- **NEW:** Create "Pending Worklist" table showing 10 sample analyses
- **NEW:** Implement dynamic sorting by P(Pneumonia) score
- **NEW:** Add color-coded priority badges (Red = Urgent, Yellow = High, Green = Standard)
- **NEW:** Show thumbnail, patient ID, upload time, and pneumonia probability

**PDF Export:**

- Use jsPDF + html2canvas to capture analysis view
- Generate downloadable PDF with all components
- Include priority classification in report

**Deliverable:** User can upload image, see analysis, and download PDF report. Worklist demonstrates intelligent triage prioritization..

****Hour 6: The "Polish" (Enhanced)"**

**Sample Dataset:**

- Prepare 6 sample images (3 normal, 3 abnormal)
- Add "Load Sample" button for instant demo

- Pre-load 10 sample analyses for Worklist demo
- Record 2-minute demo video (backup for Wi-Fi failures)

**Styling:**

- Apply Tailwind CSS for professional medical UI
- Ensure responsive design (mobile + desktop)
- Add loading spinners and error messages
- **NEW:** Style confidence floor warning prominently
- **NEW:** Color-code worklist priority badges

**Documentation:**

- **NEW:** Add DICOM endpoint documentation to API spec
- **NEW:** Include sample DICOM curl request in README
- **NEW:** Document Image Quality Gatekeeper logic

**Deliverable:** Fully functional demo with sample data; video recorded. DICOM pipeline documented; all four functional fixes integrated seamlessly..

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# 7. Success Metrics

## 7.1 Technical Metrics

| Metric | Target | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| **Inference Latency** | <500ms per image | Real-time feedback for clinicians |
| **Heatmap Accuracy** | Visually aligns with pathology | Grad-CAM must highlight relevant regions |
| **PDF Generation** | seconds | Acceptable for clinical workflow |
| **Uptime** | 99.5% | Reliable for clinical use |

## 7.2 User Experience Metrics

| Metric | Target | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| **Time to Analysis** | <10 seconds (upload + inference + display) | Reduces radiologist wait time |
| **Ease of Use** | $^{5}/_{5}$ (NPS) from test clinicians | Adoption depends on UX simplicity |
| **Report Completeness** | 100% of analyses exportable | Ensures clinical documentation |

## 7.3 Clinical Validation (Future)

- Sensitivity/Specificity on held-out test set
- Inter-observer agreement with radiologist predictions
- Clinician trust survey (Likert scale)

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## 8. Risks & Mitigation

| Risk | Impact | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| **Model accuracy below expectations** | Low clinical adoption | Use ensemble of ResNet50 + DenseNet121; validate on public datasets |
| **Grad-CAM heatmaps misaligned** | Clinician confusion | Implement manual validation; add confidence intervals; Confidence Floor prevents overconfident predictions |
| **Slow inference on CPU** | Poor UX | Deploy on GPU; implement caching for repeated images |
| **Invalid scans uploaded** | Wasted computation; user frustration | Image Quality Gatekeeper rejects invalid scans immediately with clear feedback |
| **Uncertain predictions mislead clinicians** | Diagnostic errors | Confidence Floor disables heatmap if confidence < 70%; displays uncertainty warning |
| **Clinicians miss urgent cases** | Patient harm | Smart Triage Worklist automatically prioritizes high-confidence pneumonia cases |
| **HIPAA compliance gaps** | Legal liability | Design for privacy from day 1; no PHI storage; audit logs; DICOM pipeline ready for encrypted storage |
| **Data drift (new X-ray equipment)** | Accuracy degradation | Monitor predictions; implement retraining pipeline; DICOM metadata enables equipment tracking |

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## 9. Future Roadmap

### Phase 2 (Months 2–3)

- DICOM file support (medical imaging standard)
- Multi-disease classification (14+ pathologies)

- EHR integration (HL7 FHIR)
- User authentication and audit logs

### Phase 3 (Months 4–6)

- Mobile app (iOS/Android)
- Batch processing for large datasets
- Model fine-tuning on institution-specific data
- Telemedicine integration

### Phase 4 (Months 7–12)

- FDA 510(k) clearance pathway
- Clinical trial (prospective validation)
- Regulatory compliance (HIPAA, GDPR)
- Commercial licensing model

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# Appendix A: Glossary

| Term | Definition |
|---|---|
| **Grad-CAM** | Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping; technique for visualizing model predictions |
| **Heatmap** | 2D visualization of model attention; red = high confidence, blue = low confidence |
| **Inference** | Running a trained model on new data to generate predictions |
| **Transfer Learning** | Using pre-trained weights from one task to accelerate learning on a related task |
| **Pneumonia** | Lung infection causing inflammation and fluid accumulation; visible on X-rays as consolidation |
| **Effusion** | Abnormal fluid accumulation in the pleural space; appears as opacity on X-rays |
| **Sensitivity** | True positive rate; ability to correctly identify positive cases |
| **Specificity** | True negative rate; ability to correctly identify negative cases |

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# Appendix B: Sample Workflow

**Scenario:** Dr. Sarah, an emergency physician, uses MediScan AI to triage a suspected pneumonia case.

1. **Upload:** Dr. Sarah drags a chest X-ray into the browser
2. **Analysis:** System processes image in second; displays heatmap highlighting right lower lobe consolidation
3. **Confidence:** Bar chart shows Pneumonia: 92%, Normal: 7%, Effusion: 1%
4. **Notes:** Dr. Sarah adds: “Clinical presentation consistent with bacterial pneumonia; recommend antibiotics”
5. **Report:** Clicks “Download PDF”; receives report with image, heatmap, scores, and notes

6. **Action:** Forwards report to attending radiologist for confirmation; initiates treatment

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**Document End**